United Nations General Assembly Second Committee (GA2)

COMMITTEE OVERVIEW AND MANDATE

The General Assembly was created in 1945 by the Charter of the United Nations, which established the General Assembly as one of six principal organs and the main deliberative body of the organization.[1] The General Assembly is divided into six main committees, each of which addresses a specific thematic area.[2] The Second Committee is one of the six main committees and is also known as the *Economic and Financial committee*.[3] It deals with issues related to economic growth and development, globalization, poverty eradication, food security and agriculture, and sustainability.[4]

It discusses how national, regional and international economies affect the world and focuses on how to improve the world economy to help the poor.[5] This group believes people in poverty do not have to be poor forever. For this reason, they focus on how developing nations can improve their economies. They also find ways to directly help people in poverty. They coordinate at the international level to help these countries move towards a low carbon economy by turning to renewable energy and a range of other measures that will reduce emissions.[6]

It comprises 193 UN Member States where each member has a single vote.[7] This committee also focuses on countries that have special needs. Some examples are the Least Developed Countries (LDCs) and the Landlocked Developing Countries (LLDCs).[8] It works with other international development bodies like the UN Economic and Social Council, World Trade Organization, and international financial institutions.[9]

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[1] Charter of the United Nations, 1945

[2] New Zealand Ministry of Foreign Affairs and Trade, United Nations Handbook 2017-2018, 2017, p. 23.

[3] UN General Assembly, Economic and Financial Committee (Second Committee), 2018

[4] Ibid.

[5] UNGA, *Functions and powers of the General Assembly*

[6] UN General Assembly, Transforming our world: the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development (A/RES/70/1), 2015; UN General Assembly, Economic and Financial Committee (Second Committee), 2018.

[7] UNGA, *Functions and powers of the General Assembly*

[8] UN General Assembly, Economic and Financial Committee (Second Committee), 2018

[9] UN General Assembly & UN ECOSOC, Summary by the President of the Economic and Social Council of the special high level meeting of the Council with the World Bank, the International Monetary Fund, the World Trade Organization and the United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (New York, 14 and 15 April 2014) (A/69/83-E/2014/71), 2014.

people still use this energy but it is very unhealthy and inefficient.[10] It releases carbon which is bad for the environment.[11] It gives off smoke which is bad for health and still is a major cause of death for women and children under five around the world.[12] There is also the danger of accidental fires and injury.

Nowadays almost all technology runs on energy from electricity. It has changed the lives of people around the world. But still more than 2.9 billion people lack access to modern energy sources, especially for cooking and heating, while 1.1 billion people do not have access to electricity.[13] Further global population is projected to increase by more than 2 billion people by 2050.[14]

There are many ways of producing energy and electricity. However, they can either be sustainable or unsustainable. The concept of sustainable was defined in the UN World Commission on Environment and Development's (WCED) 1987 publication *Our Common Future*. This report defined sustainable as "*development which meets the needs of the present without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs*".[15] Examples would be wind, solar, or wave power. Unsustainable means products that only have a limited amount also they are major cause of pollution and primary contributor to climate change. Examples are oil, coal and gas.

Unsustainable resources have and continued to play a dominant role in global energy systems. They provided 80% of the energy needed in order to build our modern world.[16] However they have negative impacts being the dominant source of air pollution and emitter of carbon dioxide and other green house gases.[17] It is the major cause of global warming and climate change. According to the World Meteorological Organization's Greenhouse Gas Bulletin, since 1990, greenhouse gases have caused a 43% increase the warming effect on the climate with CO_2 accounting for about 81% of this increase.[18]

Something needs to be done to reduce carbon emissions but also provide energy to all people at affordable price.

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[10] WHO, Fact sheet: Household air pollution and health

[11] Ibid.

[12] Ibid.

[13] UNDP, *UNDP Support to the Implementation of Sustainable Development Goal 7: Affordable and Clean Energy*, 2017, p. 4.

[14] UN-Energy, *Energy: A Brief Discussion on Goals, Targets and Indicators*, 2014, p. 1.

[15] UN WCED, *Our Common Future (Brundtland Report) (A/42/427)*, 1987, p. 41.

[16] Foster, The Role of Fossil Fuels in a Sustainable Energy System, *UN Chronicle*, 2015.

[17] Our world in data, fossil fuels

[18] WMO Greenhouse Gas Bulletin, No. 15 25 November 2019, p. 2.

Adopting sustainable energy practices is imperative to ensure that all sectors of society experience the social and economy benefits that energy can provide.[19] The United Nations (UN)

Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC) recognizes the importance of energy for sustainable development and poverty eradication.[20] Through the implementation of UN Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 7, "Ensure Access to Affordable, Reliable, Sustainable and Modern Energy for All," the global community commits to increasing investment in and accessibility to reliable and sustainable energy infrastructure.[21]

Recent Developments

The relationship between sustainable development and energy gained momentum in 1992 at the *Rio Summit*. In this summit major world leaders recognized sustainable development as the major challenge. Here *Agenda 21* was adopted to highlight the importance of making energy production and consumption sustainable in order to protect human health and environmental well-being.[22]

In 2000 the world leaders came together at UN headquarters to adopt the UN Millennium Declaration and set out 8 time-bound targets known as the Millennium Development Goals.[23] These were things the world's governments wanted to do in order to eradicate poverty, protect the environment, strengthen human rights, and protect the vulnerable.[24] Further, in 2002 during the World Summit on Sustainable Development (WSSD) greater emphasis was given to the importance of energy for development. Its plan of action, the *Johannesburg Plan of Implementation (JPoI)*, recognized that energy services play an essential role in *poverty alleviation*, and that the diversification of energy resources is necessary to *meet the global growing energy demand*.[25]

In 2011 Sustainable Energy for All (SEforALL) was launched by the then Secretary-General Ban Ki-moon at the UN General Assembly with the objective to bring sustainable energy to all levels of society. It is an independent, not-for-profit, international organization, with headquarters in Vienna under Austrian law.[26] It assists Member States with sustainable energy best practices through the SEforALL Knowledge Hub. The hub produces research and monitors progress based on policy and case studies. This data is presented in a comprehensive biannual report, the *Global Tracking Framework*, on sustainable energy trends and progress monitoring.[27]

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[19] Our world in data, fossil fuels

[20] UN ECOSOC, *President's Summary of 2017 High-level political forum on sustainable development*, 2017, pp. 3-9.

[21] Ibid.

[22] Rio+20 UNCSD, *The History of Sustainable Development in the United Nations*

[23] UNDP, Millennium Development Goals

[24] Ibid.

[25] Rio+20 UNCSD, *The History of Sustainable Development in the United Nations*

[26] SEforALL, governance

[27] SEforALL, history

Twenty years after the Rio summit, in 2012 at the *Rio+20 Conference* the international community *recognized energy as a priority for sustainable development*. It decided to establish a *high-level political forum* (HLPF) for sustainable development to replace the Commission on

Sustainable Development. In its outcome document, *The Future We Want*, Member States committed to improving the implementation of renewable sources of energy policies to promote the use and affordability of energy technologies and services in order to combat climate change and eradicate poverty.[28]

With General Assembly *resolution 70/1 of 2015, Transforming Our World: The 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development*, Member states adopted *17 sustainable development goals*. This framework outlined new global commitments toward poverty eradication, environmental protection, peace, and justice. Energy was recognized as a main priority and given its own goal (SDG 7), targets, and indicators to "ensure universal access to affordable, reliable and modern energy services" by 2030. It also plays an essential role in achieving other goals and targets. More than half of the world's population now lives in urban areas and this is expected to increase to 68% by 2050.[29] With an increasing number of people living in cities, sustainable energy sources and services are essential to ensure safe and healthy cities with responsible production and consumption patterns that help reduce waste and pollution and in turn minimize the carbon footprint in order to mitigate climate change.

The Paris Agreement in 2015 aims to strengthen the global response to the threat of climate change by keeping a global temperature rise this century well below 2 degrees Celsius above pre-industrial levels and to pursue efforts to limit the temperature increase even further to 1.5 degrees Celsius. It recognized the role of clean energy technologies as an integral part of combating the risks of climate change by reducing greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions.[30]

In 2016 the *New Urban Agenda* adopted at the Third UN Conference on Housing and Sustainable Development (Habitat III) established that access to clean and reliable energy is a requirement for sustainable urban development.[31]

HLPF completed its first four-year cycle under the auspices of the United Nations Economic and Social Council.[32] In these four years, it reviewed all 17 SDGs.[33] It examined progress towards the 2030 Agenda in countries in special situations and middle income countries.[34] "*It reflected on ways to improve the science policy interface and to carry forward the outcomes of ECOSOC forums on financing for development and on Science, Technology and Innovation*".[35] It was

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[28]UN General Assembly, *The Future We Want (A/RES/66/288)*, 2012, pp. 24-25.

[29]UN DESA 2018

[30]UN CC, The Paris Agreement

[31]Habitat III, The New Urban Agenda

[32]Remarks of the President of ECOSOC, H.E. Ms Inga Rhonda King, at the briefing of the President of the General Assembly, June, 2019. P. 1

[33]Ibid.

[34]Ibid.

[35]Ibid. p. 2

concluded that the world is not currently on track to reach this goal and deliberate action is required to achieve it by 2030.[36]

Addressing the Needs of Least Developed Countries

The LDCs have a long way to go to achieve universal access to modern energy by 2030.[37] "*Sustainable energy, encompassing its three dimensions of access, efficiency, and renewable energy, is a key development enabler for many SDGs*".[38] "*Despite the potential that sustainable energy has for development, many vulnerable countries, including the LDCs, still face daunting challenges*".[39] They have made considerable progress in increasing access to electricity since the adoption of the Istanbul Programme of Action in 2011. The average rate of access to electricity across LDCs reached 51% in 2017 which is an increase of 17.6% from 2010.[40] Still electricity access in LDCs remains low in comparison to the global electrification rate of 88.8% in 2017.[41]

This data hides disparities between countries and regions, as well as urban and rural areas. In 2017, on average, 79% of the urban population in LDCs had electricity access, compared with only 37.8% of rural populations.[42] Also, the Asia-Pacific LDCs have an electrification rate of 86.2% compared to 33.2% in African LDCs. It is alarming that 14 African LDCs still have electrification rates lower than 30% and the 20 least-electrified countries are all LDCs.[43]

Access to modern fuels for cooking and heating are yet further restricted in these countries. In 2017, only 14.4% of the population in LDCs had access to clean fuels and technologies for cooking.[44] In 2017, only 9 countries cover a rate of access to clean fuels and technologies for cooking higher than 30%, and 21 LDCs – all being African LDCs - had less than 5% access to clean fuels and technologies for cooking, severely impacting people's health and the environment.[45]

Technological advances continue to generate new solutions and reduced costs for clean, green energy. If these advancements are combined with increased investments, LDCs have a real opportunity to achieve SDG7 by 2030 and contribute to climate change action.[46]

Lack of funding is among the biggest challenges for LDCs in their implementation of sustainable development goals.[47] In 2015, the Third International Conference on Financing for Development

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[36]UN DESA, Global SDG 7 Conference, 2018.

[37]Accelerating SDG7 achievement, policy briefs in support of the first SDG7 review at the UN High-Level Political Forum, 2018 P.177

[38]Ibid.

[39]Ibid.

[40]Outcome document, Global Conference on Scaling-up Energy Access and Finance in Least Developed Countries, 2019

[41]Ibid.

[42]Ibid.

[43]Ibid.

[44]Ibid.

[45]Ibid.

[46]Ibid.

[47]UN, Least developed countries face challenges in funding sustainable development

achieved historic support for financing sustainable development in its outcome agreement, the *Addis Ababa Action Agenda* (AAAA), which stated that stakeholders should increase investment for clean energy technologies and improve its affordability to bring about environmental and development benefits.[48] AAAA recognized the importance of public-private partnerships as a financing mechanism to support efforts to achieve the SDGs.[49]

More focus is needed on scaling-up investment in LDCs. Current financing levels are significantly below what is required. According to current estimates, between 2018 and 2030, annual average investment globally will need to reach approximately $55 billion to expand energy access, about $700 billion to increase renewable energy, and $600 billion to improve energy efficiency.[50]

Currently investment is not spread equally, and leaves out many LDCs. Financing must be available for various types of projects, in particular people-centred smart distributed renewable energy systems, as the energy targets will not be met by only expanding the electricity grid.[51]

The central role of access to modern energy in achieving the other SDGs means that meeting SDG 7 will be central to the success or failure of the 2030 Agenda as a whole. This is why UNCTAD argues that "*the LDCs are truly the battleground on which the 2030 Agenda will be won or lost*".[52]

Promoting a Renewable Energy Revolution

Over the last few decades, the demand for energy has increased dramatically, however, an increasing number of energy alternatives have also become more feasible and affordable.[53] Through increasing access to electricity, reducing reliance on non-renewable energy resources, research on clean energy, technology transfer, and foreign direct investment, the targets under SDG 7 regarding innovation in the field of energy research may become achievable.[54]

To achieve these efforts, civil society organizations and interagency partnerships like *Sustainable Energy for All (SEforALL)* also plays pivotal role. It coordinates partnerships with public and private stakeholders to provide capacity building, knowledge sharing, and greater financing support for sustainable energy technologies and the delivery of services.[55] To date, more than 100 countries have showed their support by engaging with the organization through donations,

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[48]UN General Assembly, *Addis Ababa Action Agenda of the Third International Conference on Financing for Development (Addis Ababa Action Agenda) (A/RES/69/313)*, 2015, pp. 37-38.
[49]Ibid., pp. 15-16.
[50]Outcome document, Global Conference on Scaling-up Energy Access and Finance in Least Developed Countries, 2019
[51]Ibid.
[52]UNCTAD, The Least Developed Countries Report 2017 p. 4;
[53]UNDP, *Goal 7: Affordable and Clean Energy*, 2018.
[54]UN General Assembly, *Transforming our world: the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development (A/RES/70/1)*, 2017 p. 19; UN DESA, *Progress of Goal 7 in 2017*.
[55]SEforALL, *Strategic Framework for Results: Going Further, Faster – Together*, 2016, pp. 26-27.

building national strategies, and promoting future investment plans to deliver core objectives of SDG7.[56] SEforAll partnered with World Bank through the Lighting Africa initiative to bring electricity to sub-Saharan Africa and provide basic electricity needs to 250 million people by 2030.[57] Recently, it supported Tokelau, a small Polynesian territory in the central Pacific, in developing a national policy and strategy to increase energy efficiency through focusing on the renewable sector and partnering with New Zealand-based technology companies, which resulted in their surpassing the rest of the world in replacing fossil fuels.[58]

One way to increase commitments on energy finance and policy measures is through public-private partnerships (PPPs) which play a key role in financing energy efficiency.[59] The *UN Foundation* promotes the Clean Energy Mini-Grids initiative through PPPs to increase the delivery of reliable energy services to areas not powered by centralized energy grids.[60] These grids provide the necessary power for agricultural and industrial production.[61]

There has been a phenomenal shift towards urbanization with over 55% of world's population living in urban areas and this is expected to rise to 60% by 2030.[62] Over 90% of this growth will take place in Africa, Asia, Latin America, and the Caribbean.[63] With 70% of the global energy demand concentrated in cities, SDG 7 also affects urban populations.[64] While urban centres have access to energy, electricity may be unreliable due to outdated and unstable power grids.[65] Additionally, energy services may have high connection costs, making it unaffordable for many households.[66] Urban centres often rely on unsustainable energy sources; a high demand and usage of fossil fuels produce high levels of GHG emissions, which in turn adversely contribute to climate change.[67] They are responsible for 70% of the total greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions, though they occupy just 3 per cent of the total land space.[68]

Thus it required a fundamental transformation of how urban infrastructures and services, such as transport, energy, water, waste and urban space, are planned, delivered and maintained. It also requires effective monitoring, reporting and tracking of performance.[69] The focus is, therefore, on national and sub-national actions with domestic stakeholders to address climate change.[70] In this backdrop, cities acquire greater role in driving climate outcomes.

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[56]Sustainable Energy for All, *About us*, 2011.
[57]Lighting Africa, *About Us*, 2017.
[58]Wilson, *Pacific Island Sets Renewable Energy Record*, 2012.
[59]IEA, *Joint Public-Private Approaches for Energy Efficiency Finance*, 2011, pp. 14-15.
[60]SEforALL, *Clean Energy Mini-grids HIO Group*, 2017.
[61]Ibid.
[62]The world's cities in 2018.
[63]UN-Habitat, *Un habitat at a glance*.
[64]UN-Habitat, *World Cities Report 2016: Urbanization and Development – Emerging Futures*, 2016, p. 40.
[65]UNDP, *UNDP Support to the Implementation of Sustainable Development Goal 7: Affordable and Clean Energy*, 2017, p. 4.
[66]Ibid.
[67]UN-Habitat, *World Cities Report 2016: Urbanization and Development – Emerging Futures*, 2016, p. 16.
[68]UN-Habitat, *Un habitat at a glance*.
[69]UN-Habitat, Un habitat iclei support 60 cities to meet paris agreement goals
[70]Ibid.

Reliable, modern, and affordable energy supplies can increase access to energy services, particularly in urban areas where renewable energy resources can contribute upto 60% of the global energy supply.[71] To take advantage of this potential, the UN Human Settlements Programme (UN-Habitat) encourages Member States to implement low carbon technologies, invest in efficient energy distribution infrastructures, and change consumption patterns to save on energy use.[72] UN-Habitat and Local Governments for Sustainability (ICLEI), are collaborating to support over 60 cities, and 8 national governments, to harness the potential of urbanization to meet the Paris Agreement goals.

For instance, in Cyprus, 93 per cent of the dwellings use solar water heating resulting in major reduction in environmental pollution every year.[73] In Nuevo Leon in Mexico, ECOCASA project is being successfully run by the Mexican government and International Development Banks, which incentivizes housing developers to build homes for low income category groups, designed to minimize GHG emissions demonstrating that sustainability is compatible with affordability.[74]

UN-Habitat has asked Member States to adopt sustainable energy national policies that support cleaner energy technologies and discourage the use of unsustainable energy options.[75] UN-Habitat published a policy guide titled *Addressing Climate Change in National Urban Policy*, which contains a series of recommendations to empower Member States in these efforts.[76]

One such recommendation explores the important spatial relationship between land use and transportation planning.[77] It encourages development patterns to minimize travel distances and at the same time promoting more sustainable modes of transportation to reduced greenhouse gas emissions.[78] In particular, such approaches can cut transportation-related emissions, which represented some 14% of anthropogenic greenhouse gas emissions in 2010.[79]

With this approach Singapore and New York City regulated land use so as to sustain high usage of public transportation and curb greenhouse gas emissions. In New York, 36% of commuting trips use public transport.[80] This fairly high proportion of public transport use in a high-income city is a result of a deliberate policy of spatial concentration through high floor area ratios and

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[71]UN-Habitat, *World Cities Report 2016: Urbanization and Development – Emerging Futures*, 2016, p. 28.

[72]UN-Habitat, *Energy*, 2017.

[73]UNFCC, Cyprus Seventh National Communication & Third Biennial Report.

[74]UNFCC, ECOCASA Mexico.

[75]Ibid.

[76]UN-Habitat, *Addressing Climate Change in National Urban Policy: A Policy Guide for Low-Carbon and Climate-Resilient Urban Development*, 2016, pp. 1-2.

[77]Addressing Climate Change in National Urban Policy: A Policy Guide for Low-Carbon and Climate-Resilient Urban Development, October 2016, p.10.

[78]Ibid.

[79]IPCC AR5 WGIII, 2014

[80]Addressing Climate Change in National Urban Policy: A Policy Guide for Low-Carbon and Climate-Resilient Urban Development, October 2016, p.10.

diversification of land use through mixed zoning.[81] These measures have been coordinated with progressive removal of street parking and constant improvements to the transit system to encourage increasing public transport use.[82] While in Singapore, 52% of commuting trips are made with public transport.[83]

Another recommendation is to increasingly obtain energy from low-carbon and renewable sources, including via the decentralized or distributed provision of energy, while also promoting the more efficient consumption of energy.[84] In most countries, the generation of energy has long been a national-level responsibility, with energy distributed over long distances.[85] However the world is changing. Improvements in photovoltaic cells, accompanied by the plummeting price of solar panels and other developments, are expanding the opening for decentralized ('distributed') energy, with a potentially larger role for local governments.[86] Climate researchers point out that, for developing countries faced with an energy infrastructure gap, decentralized generation may represent an apt strategy for increasing access to energy while at the same time transitioning to renewables.[87] Examples of decentralized, low-carbon energy generation outside of OECD countries include: developing municipal solid waste-to-energy projects, e.g., in Abidjan, Cote D'Ivoire; installing solar water heaters, e.g., in Hunchun, China; regulating for solar water heaters, e.g., Nairobi in Kenya.[88]

Facilitating Rural Development

There are 1.2 billion people without electricity access, with a majority living in rural areas.[89] Four out of every five people who live without electricity are located in rural areas of South Asia and Sub-Saharan Africa. Rural areas in particular are faced with challenges in securing energy sources, because the cost of expanding electricity grids over far distances, and to areas typically less densely populated than urban areas, renders rural grid expansion a matter of lower priority. In countries with limited resources, it is not uncommon to target densely populated areas for grid electrification, because it provides the most connectivity for the money spent.[90] Even if electricity is available, it may be unreliable and unaffordable.[91] As a consequence, rural communities lack the necessary energy services to support a decent standard of living and

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[81] Ibid.

[82] Ibid.

[83] Ibid.

[84] Addressing Climate Change in National Urban Policy: A Policy Guide for Low-Carbon and Climate-Resilient Urban Development, October 2016, p.10.

[85] Ibid.

[86] Ibid.

[87] IPCC AR5 WGIII, 2014

[88] Addressing Climate Change in National Urban Policy: A Policy Guide for Low-Carbon and Climate-Resilient Urban Development, October 2016, p.10.

[89] UN DESA, *Synthesis of Energy-related Issues Highlighted in National Reports of Rio+20*, 2014, p. 28.

[90] A Survey of International Activities in Rural Energy Access and Electrification May 2014, p. 8.

[91] UN DESA, *Synthesis of Energy-related Issues Highlighted in National Reports of Rio+20*, 2014, p. 28.

promote economic productivity.[92] One solution is for Member States to adopt a decentralized renewable energy system where energy is generated and stored in off-grid locations close to where it would be used, promoting household electrification, lower energy costs, greater reliability, and lower carbon emissions.[93] UNDP's Africa Regional Energy Programme for Poverty Reduction promotes the implementation of decentralization energy solutions in rural African countries through devices that can generate power for electricity or refrigeration.[94] These devices are now serving more than 4 million people notably women in more than 3,400 villages across sub-Saharan Africa.[95] In addition to providing energy services they are also instrumental in job creation for rural women. According to a 2011 external study in Mali alone they created some 28,000 jobs.[96]

Conclusion

SDG 7 is the world's first and only global goal on energy. By dedicating a goal to energy in the 2030 Agenda, Member States acknowledged the importance of energy in sustainable development and in the achievement of the other SDGs.[97] The implementation of SDG 7 can help ensure sustainable livelihoods and alleviate poverty by lowering energy costs and increasing access to sustainable energy services through improved cooking, refrigeration, and transportation costs.[98] Services powered by clean energy technologies improve businesses, decrease emissions, and promote environmental sustainability.[99] To ensure access, affordability, and the reliability of clean energy services, global sustainable energy efforts should focus on strengthening Member States' capacity to adopt national policies and initiatives and to take advantage of clean energy technologies and delivery mechanisms to improve energy availability and efficiency.[100] To foster the implementation of SDG 7 and facilitate the 2030 Agenda, the General Assembly Second committee must remain focused in developing feasible solutions to the issue.[101] It should serve as a platform for promoting collaboration among IGOs, regional commissions, civil society, and financial institutions such as the World Bank to increase international cooperation and awareness, financial investment, capacity-building support, and accessibility to clean energy initiatives.[102]

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[92] Ibid.

[93] UNDP, *UNDP Support to the Implementation of Sustainable Development Goal 7: Affordable and Clean Energy*, 2017, p. 12.

[94] Ibid, pp. 12-13.

[95] Ibid.

[96] Ibid.

[97] IRENA, *REthinking Energy 2017: Accelerating the global energy transformation*, 2017, p. 95.

[98] Ibid, p. 96.

[99] Ibid.

[100] UN ECOSOC, *Progress towards the Sustainable Development Goals: Report of the Secretary-General (E/2017/66)*, 2017, p.9.

[101] UN DESA, *Affordable and Clean Energy: Why it Matters*, 2018.

[102] UN ECOSOC, *Progress towards the Sustainable Development Goals: Report of the Secretary-General (E/2017/66)*, 2017, p.9.

Research Questions

Delegates can consider:

1. How can high-impact countries (HICs) with rural economies reduce the usage of traditional biomass for cooking and heating?

2. How can Member States incorporate sustainable energy strategies into other SDG efforts?

3. How can developing countries be encouraged to use more renewable sources of energy?

4. What are the solutions to lack of energy in areas that cannot have a power plant close by? Examples can be small groups of people living in the desert or mountains.

5. How can Member States ensure greater access to energy in rural and impoverished urban areas?

6. What can the international community do to facilitate investment in low carbon technologies?

7. How can Member States increase affordability and reliability of energy services across all segments of society?

8. How can public, private, and civil society entities coordinate with Member States to finance and deliver sustainable energy services?

9. How do we improve the data and evidence on who and where they are, what they need, and what is working and why in order to improve decision-making and speed progress?

10. How can General Assembly Second Committee take a greater role in the implementation of SDG 7?